Screen Time vs. Dream Time: Social Media Use Linked With Worse Sleep

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Introduction

- Studies found a negative correlation between social media use and sleep quality (Hamilton et al., 2020; Tandon et al., 2020)
- Sleep deprivation causes impaired control over attention (Yaffe et al., 2014; Lee et al., 2015)
- Social media use has been found to be negatively correlated with attention (Weaver et al., 2020; Siebers et al., 2021)

Hypotheses

1. More social media use would be associated with worse sleep
2. Higher sleep quality would be linked with better attention
3. Higher social media usage would be associated with worse attention

Method

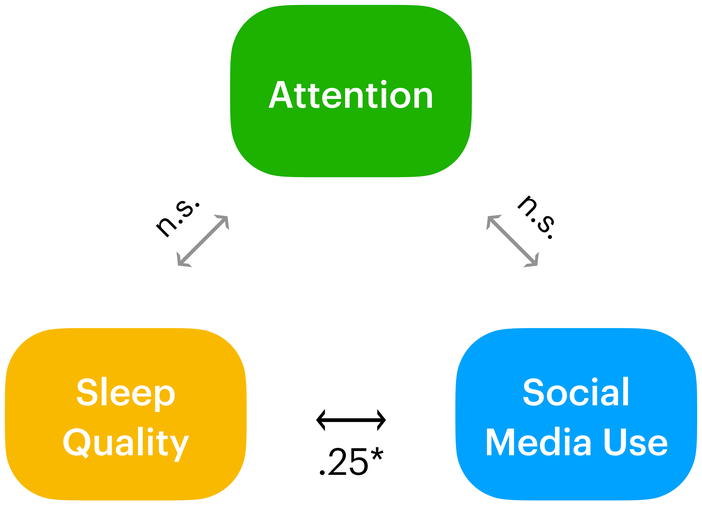
Measures

- Pittsburg Sleep Quality Index (Buysse et al., 1989)
- Mindful Attention Awareness Scale (Brown & Ryan, 2003)
- Participants were asked to report Facebook, TikTok, Instagram, and Twitter usage times from battery info automatically logged by their phone in the last 24 hours

Procedure

- Data was collected from participants on a weekday afternoon from various parts of the Palomar campus
- Palomar students that were 18 years or older completed a self-report questionnaire

Results



n.s. = Non Significant
*$p < .05$

Variables	1	2	3	*M*	*SD*
1. Social Media Use				2.41	2.03
2. Attention	-.17			3.66	0.83
3. Sleep	.25*	-.20		8.95	2.69

*$p < .05$

Participant Demographics

- 78 Palomar College Students
- Ages 18 to 30 (M = 20.49)
- Predominantly Hispanic/Latino: 66.2%

Study Design

We used a correlational study design and a convenience sample to determine the associations between social media use, attention, and sleep quality.

Conclusion

- Our findings suggest community colleges can create campaigns to promote better social media habits to improve the sleep and overall health of students
- Study Limitations: Social media data was collected over a 24-hour period which may not account for overall usage. Additionally, this study was unable to gather social media usage times from devices other than phones.

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